

Nasdaq, Inc. (NDAQ)

Equity Research Pitch: Pivot to Fintech & SaaS Excellence

RECOMMENDATION

BUY

TARGET PRICE

\$72.00 (+15.3%)

INVESTMENT HORIZON

12-18 Months

PRICE (AS OF 4/16/26) \$62.45	52-WEEK RANGE \$48.20 - \$65.10	MARKET CAP \$35.8B
P/E RATIO (NTM) 22.1x	DIVIDEND YIELD 1.54%	REVENUE GROWTH ~6-9% (Target)

Investment Thesis

1. Structural Pivot to SaaS Recurring Revenue

Nasdaq is no longer just an exchange. Over 70% of revenue now flows from scalable "Solutions" segments. This tech-heavy mix reduces reliance on trading volumes and justifies a premium valuation multiple.

2. Adenza Integration & Synergies

The acquisition of Adenza positions Nasdaq at the heart of global regulatory and risk management. Synergies are expected to accelerate cross-selling into tier-one banks, driving double-digit growth in the Financial Technology segment.

3. Leadership in Anti-Financial Crime (AFC)

As financial regulations tighten globally, Nasdaq's AFC segment (led by Verafin) acts as a high-margin, defensive growth engine with high switching costs and mission-critical utility.

| Risk Analysis

Regulatory Volatility: Changes in SEC market structure rules could pressure the Cash Equities business. **Execution Risk:** Large-scale integration of Adenza is complex; however, management has a strong track record of successful M&A absorption.

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